

Assessment Two (2): The Research Proposal

Research Methods for IT Professionals

REM474S, REM475S, REM477S

DUE DATE: Wednesday 3 June 2020 @ 4pm (30%)

Produce a full research proposal that describes and outlines the empirical research project you are planning to undertake as part of the assessment requirements for this subject. For your Advanced Diploma studies you are required to plan, design and implement a small scale empirical research project based within the IT Professional context. **You are required to work in pairs.**

Assessment Criteria

- Appropriate research design decision-making
- Suitable identification of research problem and objectives
- Suitable and accurate choice research methods and tools
- Understanding and adherence to proposal guideline
- Academic language, presentation and writing style

Technical Requirements

A) The proposal must be structured to include the following headings listed below. Also use the guideline document attached to this brief that provides additional detail on the level of detail and type of descriptions each section of your proposal must include. The proposal must be a **maximum of four pages**.

1. *Title*
2. *Key words*
3. *Introduction and background*
4. *Literature Review*
5. *Research Problem / Problem Statement*
6. *Research Objectives*
7. *Research Questions*
8. *Research Methods*
9. *Research Ethics*
10. *Budget & Timeline*
11. *Reference List*

- B) You have to work in pairs, ensure that both your names are clearly listed on the cover page
- C) Number the pages of your proposal
- D) Only one student must upload the completed written research proposal via Blackboard
- E) No email submissions will be accepted
- F) Normal late submission penalties will apply

GUIDELINES for Advanced Diploma RESEARCH PROPOSAL DEVELOPMENT, 2020

The following guidelines are intended to provide you with a general overview of how to develop and create a research proposal able to describe your research planning for your Ad Diploma research project.

Title

The title must be appropriate – thus capture the research topic, but should be concise (under 15 words) and have impact. Try not to include references to the conclusion.

Key words

Provide five (5) words that convey what your research is about. The key words should be in a particular sequence: the first should give a broad indication of the field/topic of the research, the second should give a more specific indication, the third should be even more specific, and so on

Introduction and background to the study

The purpose of an introduction is to provide a broad overview of the study. Ensure you include a discussion /description that a) orientates the reader towards the industry/sector that experiences the problem. Try and set the scene as to why the research or technical artefact is relevant or important; b) the theory relating to the topic at hand, contextualising the research and introducing the specific literature on the topic; c) introduce the different components of the proposal.

Literature Review

Provide evidence that you are well acquainted with past and current research in the field of study. Make a case for why your research will not duplicate past or current research. It is also important to indicate how the intended research relates to similar and past research; in other words, the literature review positions your research within the existing body of knowledge.

Problem Statement

This is the heart of the proposal. Normally a sentence, or at most a paragraph. Identify and describe what the research problem is and why investigating or trying to solve this problem is important to the IT profession. The problem statement should ideally link with the Introduction and background to the study.

Research Objectives

State what the general objectives of your research are. These should/can link to the primary research problem. Any sub-objectives should/can link to the secondary research problem.

Research Questions

You might find it helpful to prioritize one or two main questions, from which you can then derive a number of secondary research questions.

Research Methods

In this section you need to demonstrate that you have a complete understanding of the possible methodological tools and approaches available (be they qualitative and/or quantitative), and be able to justify the specific approach selected to substantiate the proposed research project. Ideally there should be a link between the chosen methods and the stated research questions. Offer a clear and detailed description of the type of research you intend to conduct. Also provide information or discuss the following aspects of your research methods, **making sure that you also offer suitable motivations for your decision**; the application, objectives and mode of enquiry of your research; population, sample, sampling techniques you will use; data collection instruments, procedures, techniques applied; how you will analyse your data.

Research Ethics

If your research will involve people and /or animals as research subjects, you have to include an ethics statement in your proposal. Such a statement is an indication of your awareness of the ethical considerations and an agreement to conduct your research in accordance with ethical procedures. Mention any ethical issues arising from your study and state briefly how they may be dealt with.

Budget & Timeline

Provide a timeline associated with your research undertaking. List all the research activities you will undertake (using the research process/steps as a guideline) and assign a specific time to each of these tasks/activities. Indicate the intended rand value to be spent on the research.

Reference List

This is a list of the literature referred to in your research proposal. Do not include titles not cited, or that have no relevance to your research problem. You should have read the references you list (or at least the relevant parts)

Sources: Guideline documents produced by the following South African universities: North West University, University of Johannesburg, University of the Western Cape, Cape Peninsula University of Technology, University of the Free State.